

A LETTER TO GOD

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~Summary~

Lencho's Hope of Good Harvest

Lencho was a farmer who lived on the crest of a low hill with his family. His was the only house in the entire valley. His field was full of ripe corn and easily visible from the house. He was eagerly waiting for a good rain to have a good harvest so he could earn money for his family.

Turning of Lencho's Hope into Despair

As Lencho hoped, it started raining at the time of supper which gave Lencho a ray of hope. He was extremely delighted to see that. He compared the raindrops with coins which shows his joy. But soon his joy turned into despair as the rain changed into hailstones which ruined the crops. The field had been covered with snow like a layer of white salt. Lencho was worried for his family.

Lencho's Firm Belief in God

Though Lencho was a poor farmer and had lost all his crops, he had firm faith in God. He found in God his last hope and decided to write a letter to God for help. He asked God to send him a hundred pesos so that he could sow his field again and support his family until the new crops were harvested. He also wrote that if God didn't help him, his family would die of hunger.

The Postmaster's Reaction to Lencho's Letter

After reading Lencho's letter to God, the postmaster laughed but soon realised that Lencho had firm faith in God and his belief should not be shaken. So, he decided to help Lencho with the help of his post office employees. He collected seventy pesos and handed the envelope to Lencho himself in which he also contributed a part of his salary.

Lencho Addresses the Post Office Employees 'A Bunch of Crooks'

Lencho became angry when he saw seventy pesos in the envelope as he had demanded a hundred pesos. He did not believe that God could do such a mistake and send him less money. So, he decided to write a letter again for the rest of money. In this letter, he requested God not to send the rest of the money through the money order because he thought that the post office employees were a 'bunch of crooks' who might have stolen his money.

Justification of the Title

It aptly captures the essence of Lencho's faith and the story's message of hope and generosity.

Message

The lesson conveys that the faith can give strength in difficult times, but it is equally important to trust and appreciate the kindness of others. It highlights the value of generosity, empathy and hope, teaching us to believe in humanity alongside our faith in God.

Themes

- Faith in God
- Hope and optimism
- Human kindness and compassion
- Irony and blind faith
- Conflict between human and nature
- Resilience and perseverance

Character Sketch

Lencho is a simple, hardworking, and deeply religious farmer with unwavering faith in God. After a devastating storm destroys his crops, his innocence and conviction lead him to write a letter to God requesting money. The Postmaster is an amiable, kind, generous, and empathetic individual. He is moved by Lencho's profound faith and decides to help him by collecting money from his colleagues to keep that faith intact.

Lencho

- **Hardworking Farmer:** Described as "an ox of a man," he works tirelessly in his fields to support his family.
- **Unwavering Faith:** He believes entirely that God sees all and will not let him die of hunger.
- **Innocent and Naive:** His innocence is shown through his belief that a letter addressed "To God" will reach Him.
- **Simpleton with Limited Perspective:** He is suspicious of people and calls the compassionate post office employees "a bunch of crooks," not knowing they helped him. **Character**

The Postmaster

- **Amiable and Kind-hearted:** He is a fat, friendly, and compassionate person who takes his job seriously.
- **Generous and Empathetic:** Instead of mocking the strange letter, he feels empathy for Lencho and is moved by his faith.
- **A "God-fearing" Man:** He does not want to shake Lencho's faith in God, so he acts as a divine agent.
- **Benevolent:** He contributes part of his own salary and goes out of his way to collect money for a stranger.

Key Comparison

- **Lencho** represents ultimate faith and naive honesty.
- **The Postmaster** represents human compassion, practical generosity, and secular kindness.
- **Their interaction** shows a contrast between blind faith (Lencho) and, ironically, human kindness from strangers (Postmaster) who are mistaken for thieves.

Practice Questions:

1. In a society that often seeks recognition for "good deeds," what is the moral significance of anonymous service? Does the postmaster's decision to hide his identity make his sacrifice more or less valuable?
2. What does the postmaster's decision to answer the letter—even when it required "something more than goodwill, ink and paper"—teach us about the value of empathy and the quiet nature of true humanity?

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